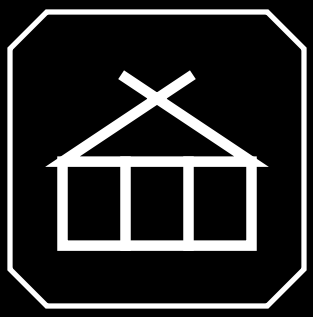


DOVA STASH

EDITOR



USER GUIDE

Make a home template without starting the game: open a home, give each container its job, check it, save it.

EDITION
Preview · October 2026

FOR
Dova Stash Editor, in the Dova Stash download

PROJECT
github.com/Kexodus/DovaStash

CONTENTS

01 WHAT THE EDITOR IS FOR 03
Templates, and what you need

02 INSTALL AND ADD IT TO MO2 04
Tools, Executables, arguments

03 THE START PAGE 05
Your setup, three ways in, homes in progress

04 OPENING A HOME 06
Homes by mod, the 3D view, moving around

05 THE FLOOR PLAN 08
A quick map, one floor at a time

06 SETTING UP CONTAINERS 09
Master, categories, ignore, notes

07 FASTER EDITING 11
Paint mode, multi-select, undo and redo

08 DISPLAYS 13
Racks, mannequins, plaques and bookshelves

09 DRAFT ALL HOMES 14
Suggestions with reasons, then review

10 WHERE ITEMS GO 16
Preview the sort before you play

11 MULTI-CELL HOMES AND DOORS 18
Cellars, upper floors, the grounds outside

12 CHECKING AND SAVING 19
Problems, backups, the Templates mod

13 TROUBLESHOOTING AND FAQ 20
Answers to common questions

14 CONTROLS REFERENCE 21
Every key and click on one page

READING THIS GUIDE

Each chapter is one task. Screenshots carry **numbered marks**; the list under the picture explains each number.

Names you click or type in the editor look like **Save template**. Keys look like Ctrl S.

THE HOMES IN THE PICTURES

Whitepeak Tower, Aldamar and Lakeview Manor, in a load order of about 300 plugins. Your homes and numbers will differ; the steps are the same.

01

WHAT THE EDITOR IS FOR

Dova Stash sorts your loot into the containers of a player home. A **template** tells it which container takes what in one particular home. The editor makes templates for you, outside the game.

OPEN A HOME

Every home of your load order, under the mod that adds it.

SET UP THE CHESTS

Click it in 3D or on the plan: master, categories, or ignored.

CHECK AND SAVE

The same checks the game runs, then one file in its own mod.



FIGURE 1 Breezehome as the editor draws it, from your own meshes and textures.

A TEMPLATE SAYS

- which container is the **master**, where anything without a place goes,
- which **categories** each other container takes (potions, ingots, books…),
- which containers to **ignore** (ones that respawn or belong to someone),
- which racks, mannequins and shelves to fill.

YOU NEED

- Windows 10 or 11 with Direct3D 11,
- Skyrim Special Edition or Anniversary Edition, set up with Mod Organizer 2 (or a plain Data folder),
- Dova Stash installed. The editor comes with it.

The editor only reads your game and mod files. It never changes a plugin. It writes template files only, into a mod of their own.

02

INSTALL AND ADD IT TO MO2

The editor is one program, `DovaStashEditor.exe`. It is already in the Dova Stash download, in the mod's **Tools** folder. Add it to Mod Organizer 2 once, like xEdit.

1. In MO2, open **Tools** › **Executables** (the gears icon), press **+** and choose **Add from file...**
2. Browse to your Dova Stash mod folder, open **Tools** and pick `DovaStashEditor.exe`.
3. Fill in the fields as below, then press **OK**.
4. Pick **Dova Stash Editor** in MO2's run list (top right) and press **Run**.

EDIT EXECUTABLES	WHAT TO ENTER
Title	Dova Stash Editor
Binary	`<MO2 folder>\mods\Dova Stash\Tools\DovaStashEditor.exe`
Start in	`<MO2 folder>\mods\Dova Stash\Tools`
Arguments	`--mo2 "<MO2 folder>" --gui` optional: run from MO2, it finds the instance itself
Create files in mod instead of overwrite	leave off the editor writes into its own mod

WITHOUT MO2

Double-click the exe, or start it from a terminal with `--mo2 "<MO2 folder>"`. Outside MO2 it rebuilds the same view of your Data folder by itself, so it gives the same answers. With no MO2 at all, point it at the game with `--data "<Skyrim>\Data"`.

THE FIRST START

The editor finds MO2's instance and profile, reads your load order (about a second for 300 plugins) and counts your player homes. If it cannot find the instance, it asks once for the folder and remembers it.

TIP

To open one home straight away, add it to the arguments: `--gui --mod 92177 --cell bcr58WhiteTower` opens Whitepeak Tower (Nexus id 92177).

03

THE START PAGE

Every session starts here. It shows that your setup was found, how many homes your load order has, and the homes you are working on.

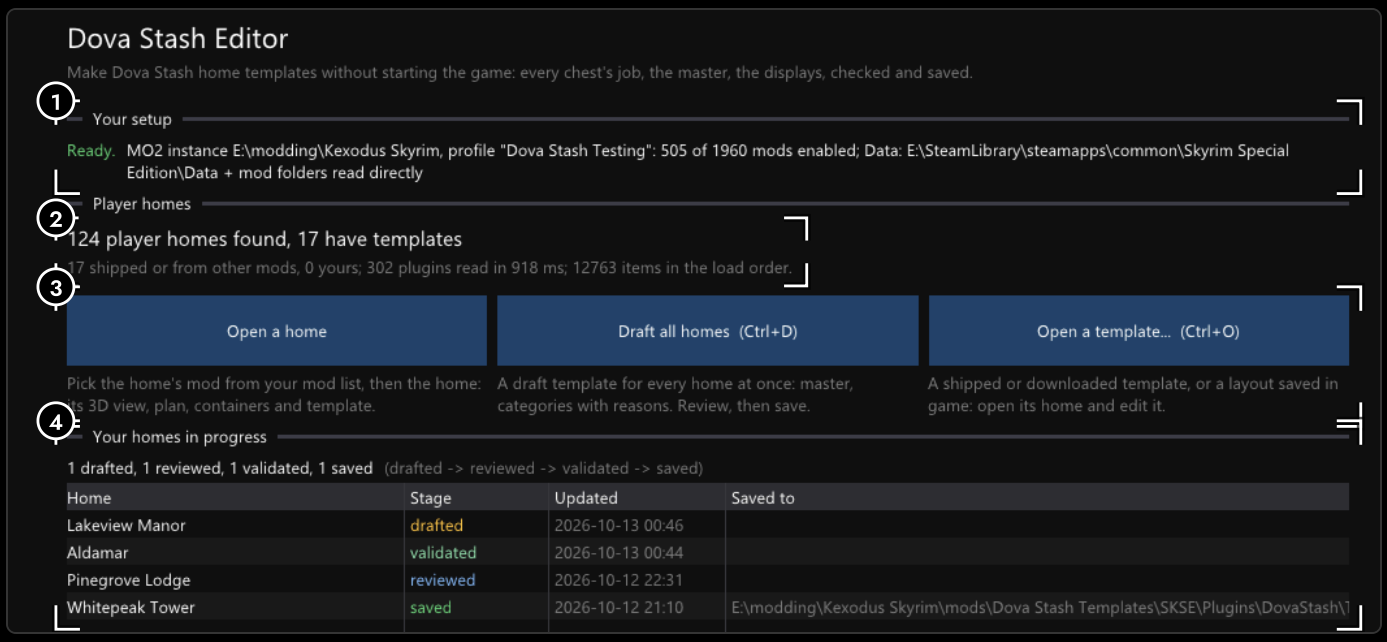


FIGURE 2 The start page, with four homes in progress.

1. **Your setup.** The MO2 instance, profile and Data folder in use. Change them in the bar at the top (**Browse...**, **Profile**).
2. **Player homes.** Every home in your active load order, and how many already have a template.
3. **Three ways in. Open a home** under its mod, **Draft all homes** at once, or **Open a template...** you already have.
4. **Your homes in progress.** Each home you touched, with its stage. Click one to carry on.

STAGES

DRAFTED — You opened its draft. →

REVIEWED — You accepted or rejected a suggestion, or edited it. →

VALIDATED — Reviewed, and no problems left. →

SAVED — Written to disk. The list shows where.

Stages, your MO2 folder and your author name are kept between runs, in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\DovaStashEditor\state.json`.

04

OPENING A HOME

You know a home by its mod. **Open a home** lists every home of your load order under the mod that adds it; a name or a Nexus id finds it.

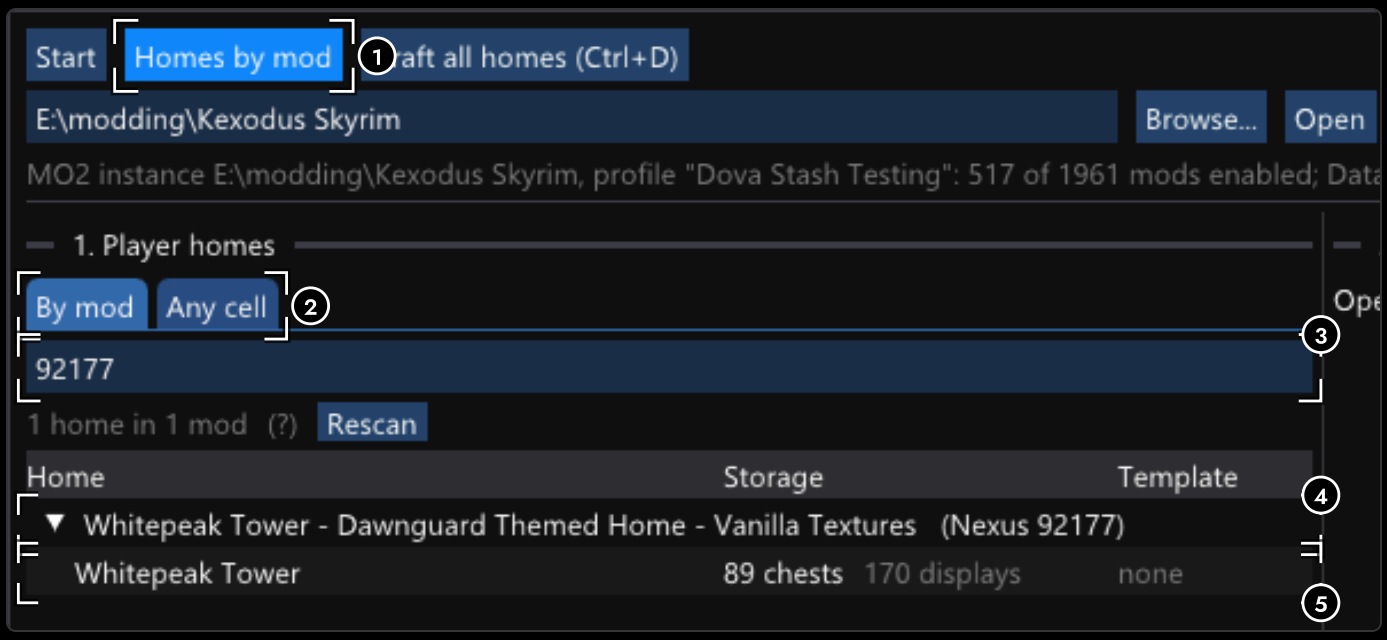


FIGURE 3 Homes by mod: every home of your load order under its mod. A name or Nexus id finds it.

1. **Homes by mod** tab.
2. **By mod** lists the homes; **Any cell** is for a home that is not listed.
3. **Filter.** Part of the home or mod name, or the Nexus id (`92177` is Whitepeak Tower).
4. **The mod** with its Nexus id. Point at it to see its plugins.
5. **The home** with its storage and template. Click it to open it.

HOW THE EDITOR FINDS HOMES

It reads every cell of your load order once and keeps the homes: a player-house location, owned by the player, or mannequins and nothing that respawns. Each sits under the mod whose plugin adds it; base-game and DLC homes sit under **(Game Data folder)**. **Rescan** (F5) reads it again after you change mods in MO2.

A home owned by a faction, or an exterior, is not listed. In **Any cell**, pick its mod: every cell of its plugins with containers is ranked, likely homes first. Untick **Likely homes only** to see them all.

The list stays beside the cell while you go from one home to the next. **Hide lists**, at the top left of the cell, gives the cell the whole window; **Homes** brings it back. A home opened from **Draft all homes** or a template file starts with the list folded away.

MOVING AROUND IN 3D

DO THIS	TO
Hold right mouse, move the mouse	Look around
Right mouse held + W A S D, Q E	Fly; Q and E go down and up. Shift is 4× faster, Alt slower
Mouse wheel	Move forward or back (with right mouse held: change speed)

THE 3D VIEW

The home as it looks in game, built from your own meshes and textures. It opens from above while the meshes load.

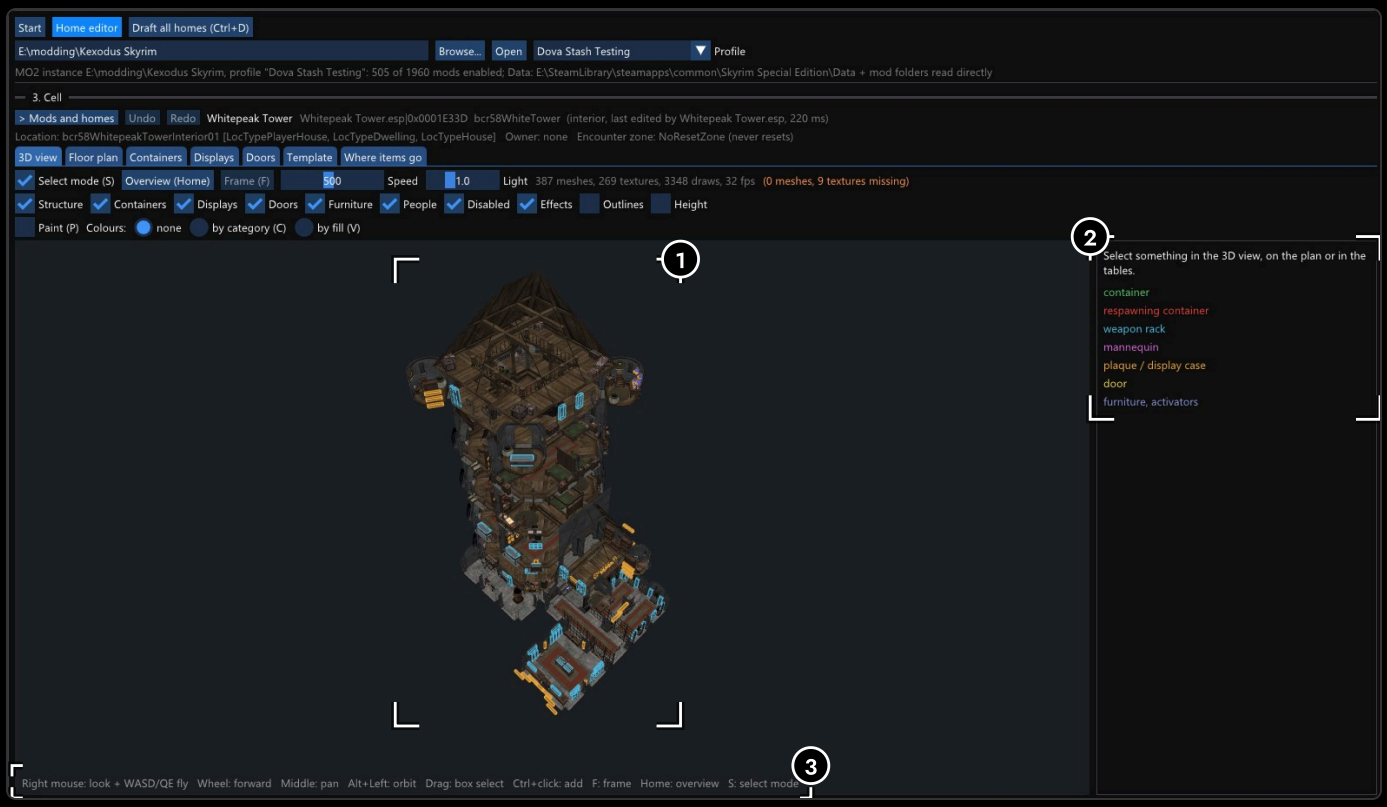


FIGURE 4 A home open in the 3D view (Whitepeak Tower, from above).



FIGURE 5 The cell's tabs and the 3D view's toolbar.

1. **The home.** Hover anything to see its name; click to select it.
2. **Details pane.** With nothing selected it shows the colour key.
3. **Hint bar**: the controls for the mode you are in.
4. **Tabs** for this cell: 3D view, Floor plan, Containers, Displays, Doors, Template, Where items go.
5. **Select mode** (S): on, a click picks what a template can use. **Overview** (Home), **Frame** (F), **Speed**, **Light**.
6. **Layers.** Hide structure, people, disabled upgrades or effects. **Height** cuts a tower into floors.
7. **Paint** and **Colours**: see chapters 07 and 10.

WHAT THE COLOURS MEAN

Things you cannot see in game but a template can use, such as hidden chests and rack triggers, are drawn as see-through boxes: green containers, red respawning containers, blue weapon racks, magenta mannequins, orange plaques and cases, yellow doors, lavender furniture. A gray checker is a texture the editor could not find; it does not matter for the template.

05

THE FLOOR PLAN

The plan draws every object's footprint from above, north up. It is the fastest way to find a room or pick something that is hard to reach in 3D. Plan and 3D view share one selection.

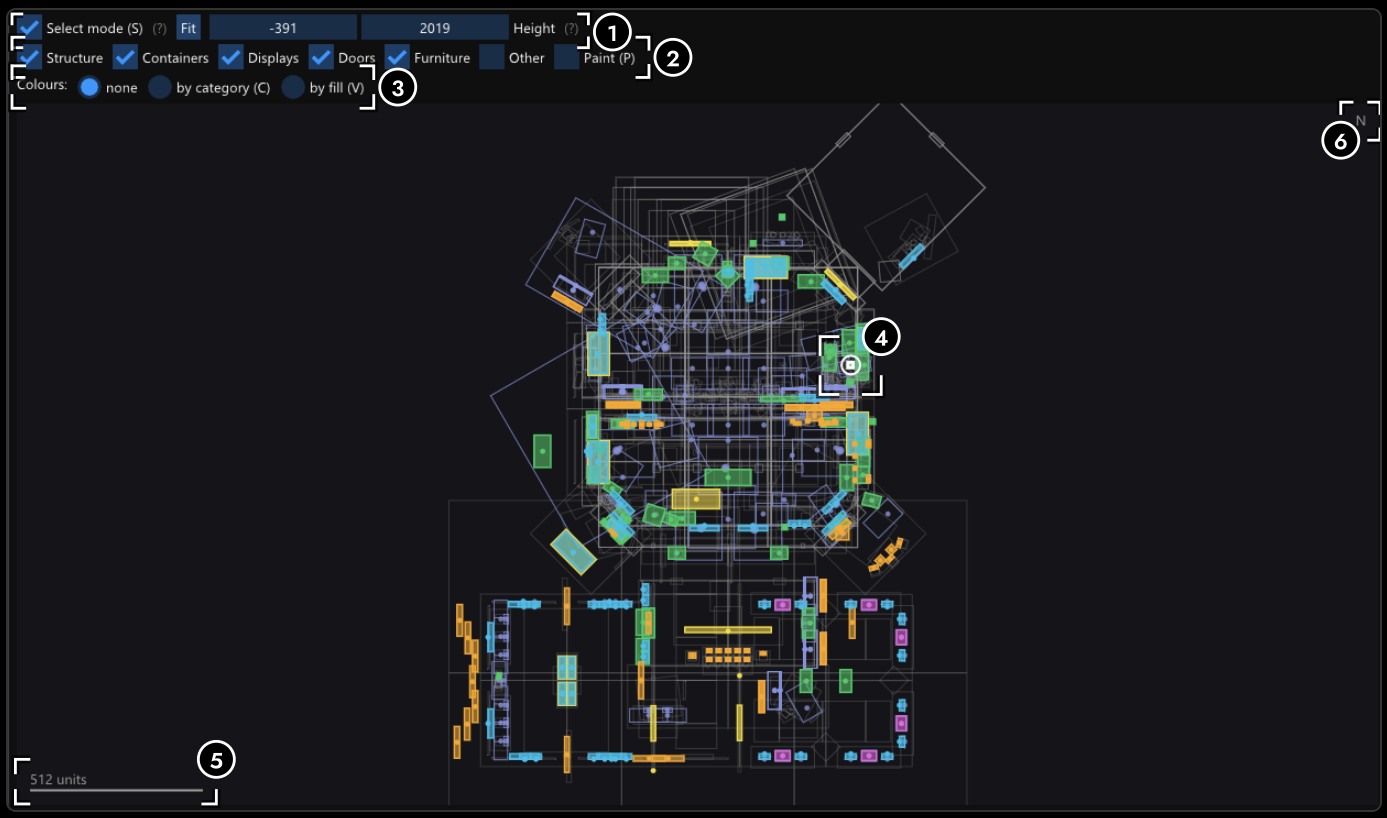


FIGURE 6 The floor plan: the same home seen from above, north up.

1. **Select mode**, **Fit** (the whole cell in view) and **Height**: the lowest and highest heights shown. Narrow it to see one floor.
2. **Layers**: structure, containers, displays, doors, furniture, other.
3. **Colours**, as in the 3D view.
4. **The selection**, marked on the plan.
5. **Scale bar**, in game units.
6. **North.**

ON THE PLAN

- Mouse wheel zooms, right or middle drag pans.
- Left click selects. With select mode off, left drag pans.
- Hover a footprint to see its name.

THEN IN 3D

Select a chest on the plan, switch to **3D view** and press F. The camera finds a side of it where no wall is in the way.

06

SETTING UP CONTAINERS

Click a container in 3D, on the plan or in the **Containers** tab. Its details open on the right: what it is, its reference and base object, then, under **In the template**, the role editor.



FIGURE 7 Selected in 3D: the potion basket gets a yellow frame and its details open on the right.



FIGURE 8 The role editor for a container.

1. **Make master**: this container takes everything without a place of its own, and is the hotkey's target. A home has one master; the old one becomes a plain container.
2. **Label**: the name players see. It starts as the game's name.
3. **Ignored**: Dova Stash never uses it.
4. **Categories** it takes. **Add a category…** opens the category tree; **x** removes one.
5. **Note** for people who read the file.
6. **Remove from the template**: it is no longer listed (unlisted containers stay unused).

CHOOSING THE MASTER

Pick a large chest near the front door that never respawns. It is the home's inbox: whatever has no container of its own ends up there. The master's details say *Master container* and offer **Not the master**.

CATEGORIES

Categories come from Dova Stash's category files, the same ones the game uses. They form a tree: `alchemy.potions`, `misc.ores_ingots`, `weapons.staves`. A name ending in `.*` takes the whole group, so `weapons.*` takes every weapon. When two containers take the same items, the more exact category wins.

IGNORE WHAT IS NOT SAFE



FIGURE 9 A respawning urn: the draft already ignores it, with the reason as its note.

1. **Respawns: never bind it.** Containers that reset lose what you put in them. The editor marks them in red.
2. **Ignored** is ticked.
3. **The reason** goes in the note, so other players know why.

Ignore containers that respawn, belong to someone else, or disappear with a house upgrade. The draft (chapter 09) does this for you and writes the reason.

EVERY CONTAINER IN ONE TABLE

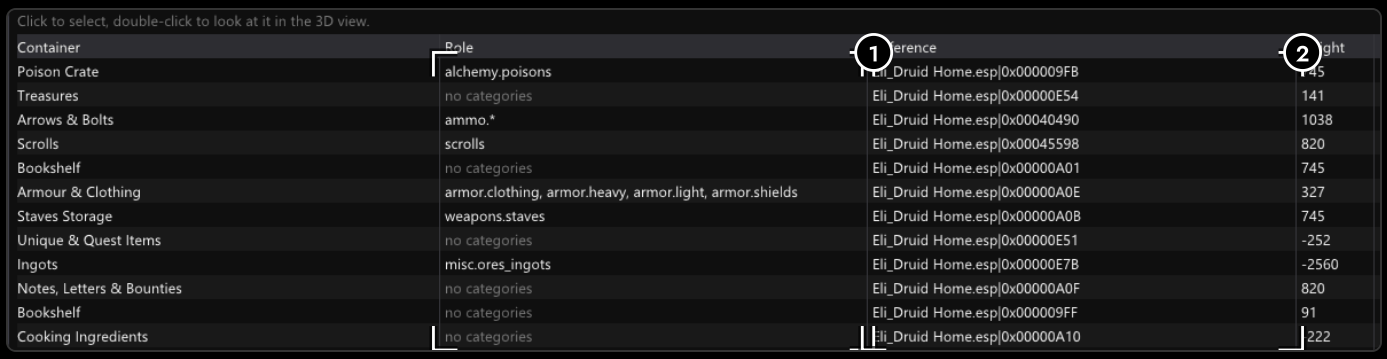


FIGURE 10 The Containers tab lists every container with its role; click a row to select it.

1. **Role**: its categories, *no categories*, *ignored* or *not listed*.
2. **Reference**. Click a row to select it; double-click to look at it in 3D. Hidden chests you cannot click are reachable here.

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
>
> A container with no categories still matters: it stays empty, and its items go to the master. In **Where items go** (chapter 10) it shows as *receives nothing*.

07

FASTER EDITING

PAINT MODE

Press P (or tick **Paint**), pick a category, then click containers, racks and mannequins to give it to them. Click again to take it away. The master, respawning and ignored containers tell you why they cannot be painted.



FIGURE 11 Paint mode with alchemy.potions picked. Colours switch to "by category" while you paint.

1. **Paint** on, with the category to paint.
2. **By category** colours and their key.
3. **Click a container** to give it the category; click again to take it away.
4. **Hint bar**: what a click does now. P stops painting.

> **TIP**
>
> Paint a room at a time: narrow **Height** to one floor, pick a category, and click every chest that should take it. Painted containers change colour at once, so you see what is left.

UNDO AND REDO

Every change to the template can be undone: Ctrl Z undoes, Ctrl Y (or Ctrl Shift Z) redoes, or use **Undo** and **Redo** next to the home's name. A text field counts as one step once you leave it. The editor keeps 200 steps, also while you move between the home's cells.

MULTI-SELECT

Ctrl + click adds or removes one object, in 3D, on the plan or in the tables. In select mode, drag a box to select every container and display inside it (hold Ctrl to add). Esc clears the selection.

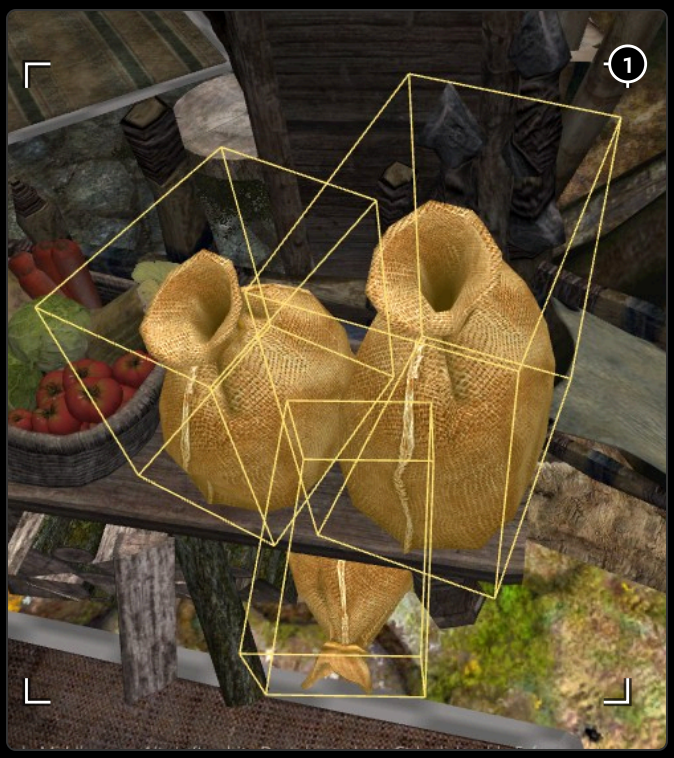


FIGURE 12 Three sacks selected at once.

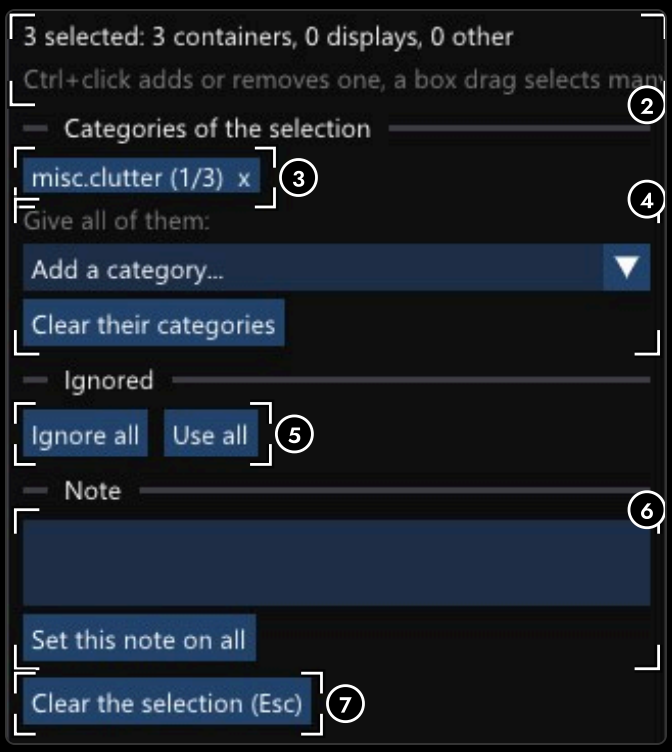


FIGURE 13 The details pane edits them together.

1. **Three sacks**, each in its own frame.
2. **How many** are selected, by kind.
3. **Categories of the selection**, with how many have each (1 of 3). **x** takes it from all.
4. **Give all of them** a category, or **Clear their categories**.
5. **Ignore all** or **Use all**.
6. **One note** for all of them.
7. **Clear the selection** (Esc).

UNSAVED CHANGES

While a template has changes that are not saved, the top bar says ** unsaved changes*, the cell header says *(template not saved)* and the **Template** tab has a star. Closing the window asks first.

08

DISPLAYS

Racks, mannequins, plaques, display cases and bookshelves are **displays**. Dova Stash fills the ones the template uses with your best gear. Nothing is ever taken off a display.

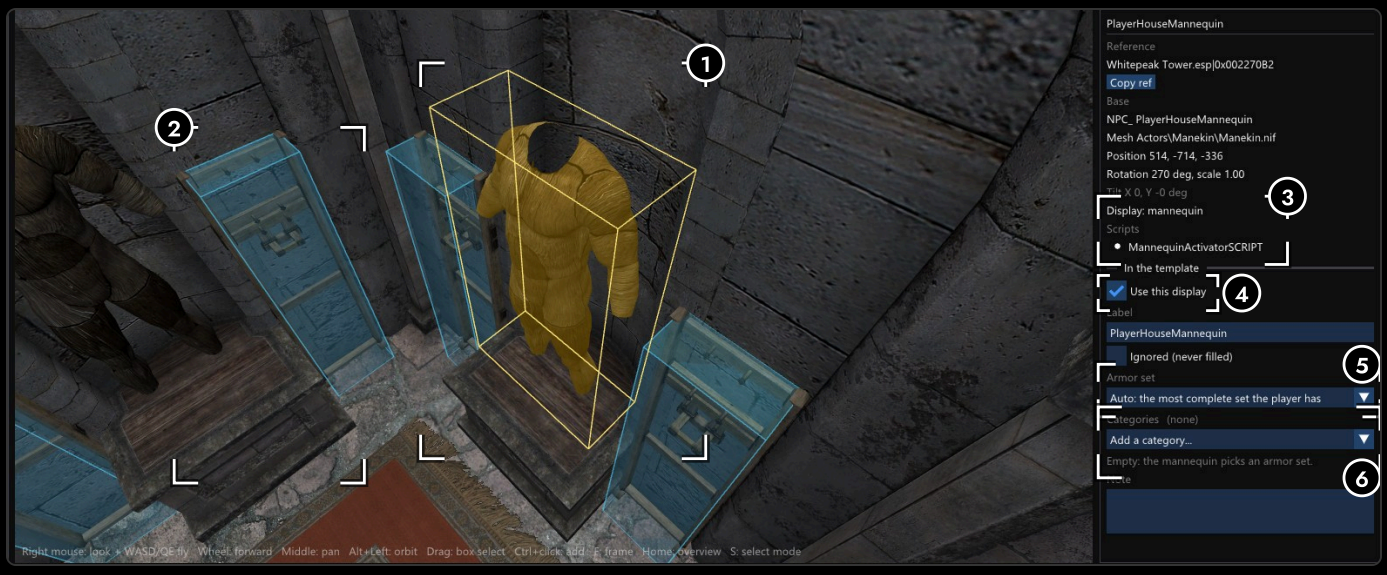


FIGURE 14 A mannequin selected in Whitepeak Tower. The blue see-through boxes are weapon-rack triggers.

1. **The mannequin**, selected.
2. **Rack triggers**, drawn as blue see-through boxes so you can click them.
3. **Display: mannequin** and the script that makes it one.
4. **Use this display**: Dova Stash fills it. Untick to leave it alone.
5. **Armor set**: *Auto* wears your most complete set; pick one (type to search every set of your load order) and it wears only that set, filling up as you get its pieces.
6. **Categories**, for *Auto* only. Empty: any set.

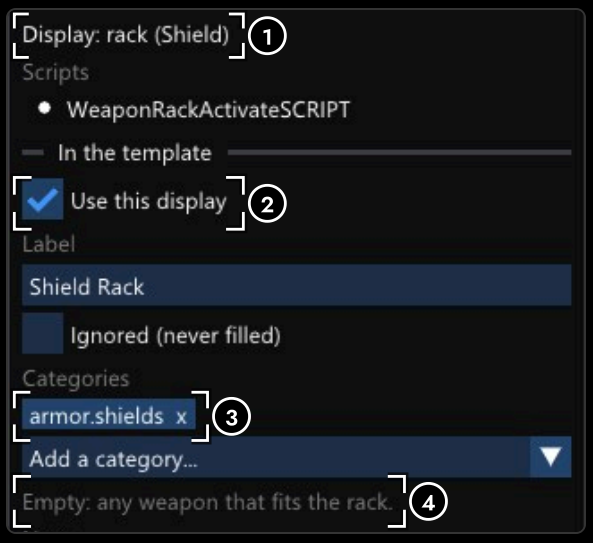


FIGURE 15 A shield rack: its kind decides what fits.

1. **Kind** of rack: any weapon, no daggers or bows, daggers, or a shield.
2. **Use this display.**
3. **Categories**: `armor.shields` here; a bow rack could take `weapons.bows`.
4. **Empty** means any weapon that fits the rack.

Plaques and display cases

Each keeps what its own script was made for, such as a dragon priest mask. The editor lists those items for you.

Bookshelves

Listed in the **Displays** tab with the racks and plaques. Give one categories (skill books, spell tomes, notes) or leave it empty for the books most worth showing.

09

DRAFT ALL HOMES

Instead of starting from nothing, let the editor draft a template for every home in your load order. Open it from the start page, the top bar or Ctrl D.

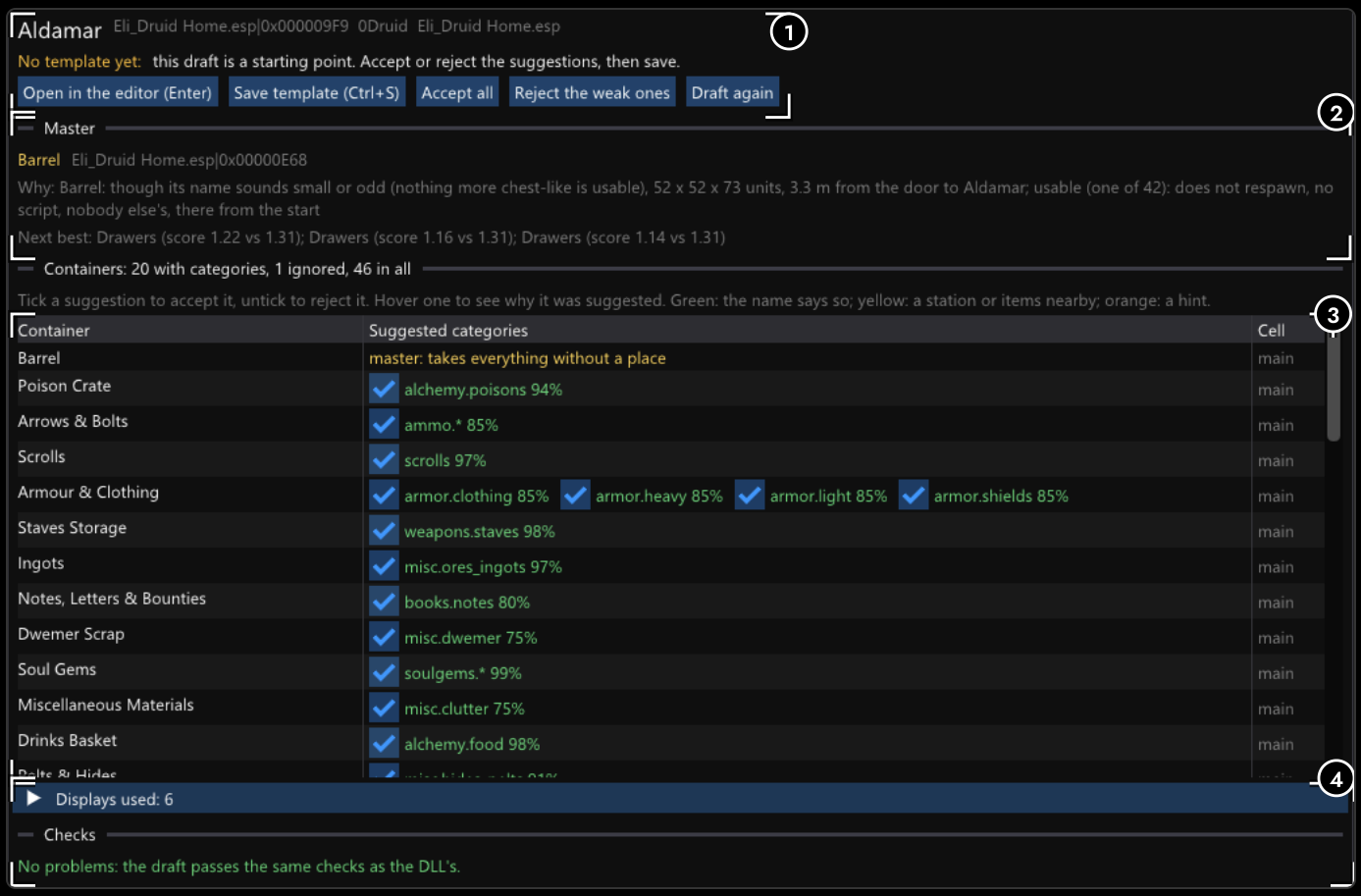


FIGURE 16 Draft all homes: the draft for Aldamar, with its master and suggestions.

1. **The home**, whether it has a template, and the actions: **Open in the editor** (Enter), **Save template** (Ctrl S), **Accept all**, **Reject the weak ones**, **Draft again**.
2. **The master** and why it was chosen, with the next best.
3. **Suggested categories** per container, as checkboxes with a confidence. Hover one to read its reason.
4. **Displays used** (click to open the list) and **Checks**: the draft against the game's own rules.

COLOURS AND CONFIDENCE

Green: the container's name says so. **Yellow**: a crafting station or items nearby. **Orange**: a weaker hint, such as the kind of furniture. The number is the confidence; hover a suggestion to read its reason. Each category goes to one container and is ticked from 50%. Unticked ones are the alternatives (*Potion Basket has it with 93%*).

THE LIST OF HOMES

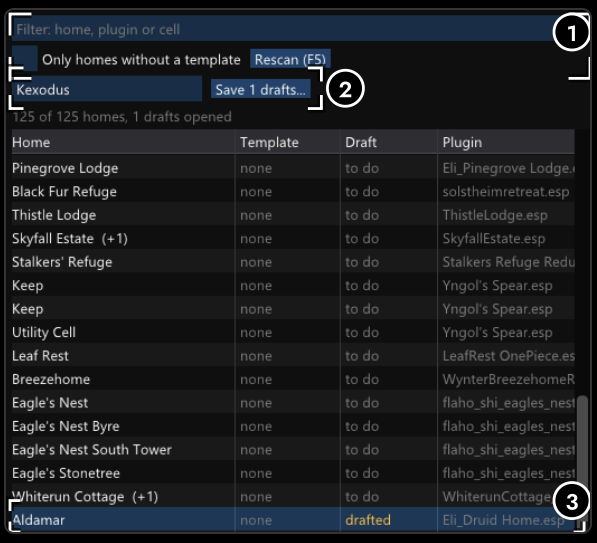


FIGURE 17 The list of homes.

1. **Filter** by home, plugin or cell; **Only homes without a template**; **Rescan** (F5).
2. **Your author name**, and **Save N drafts...** for every opened draft at once.
3. **Every home**, its template (none, shipped, yours) and its stage. ↑ ↓ step through them.

WHERE THE SUGGESTIONS COME FROM

The name

A container called *Soul Gems*, *Ingots* or *Potion Basket* takes those, and only those. Homes with named containers come out nearly complete. A name the editor cannot read, such as *Dragonpriest Masks*, gets nothing: you decide.

What is near it

A chest by the forge gets ores and ingots; one by the alchemy lab, ingredients and potions. Items placed on it add to that; decoration, like a shield on the wall, says nothing.

The master

A chest near the front door, never one named for what it holds. Containers that respawn, are owned, or are scripted are never chosen.

The rest

Common groups nobody took (clothes, books, food...) go to the free container with the best hint, such as a dresser for clothes or a safe for jewelry.

REVIEWING A DRAFT

1. Read the master and its reason. If it is wrong, open the home and make another container the master.
2. Go down the containers. Tick what fits, untick what does not. **Reject the weak ones** clears the low ones in one go.
3. Press **Open in the editor** to finish in 3D: rename labels, set up displays, check **Where items go**. Your changes come back to the drafts view.
4. Press **Save template**. Or open several drafts and save them all with **Save N drafts...** (homes without a template only).

HOMES THAT ALREADY HAVE A TEMPLATE

The drafts view says how many categories the draft sends to the same container as the existing template. Saving asks first; the old file is kept as a backup.

10

WHERE ITEMS GO

The **Where items go** tab runs Dova Stash's own sorting over a sample of loot and shows which container would get what. It runs again by itself whenever the template changes.

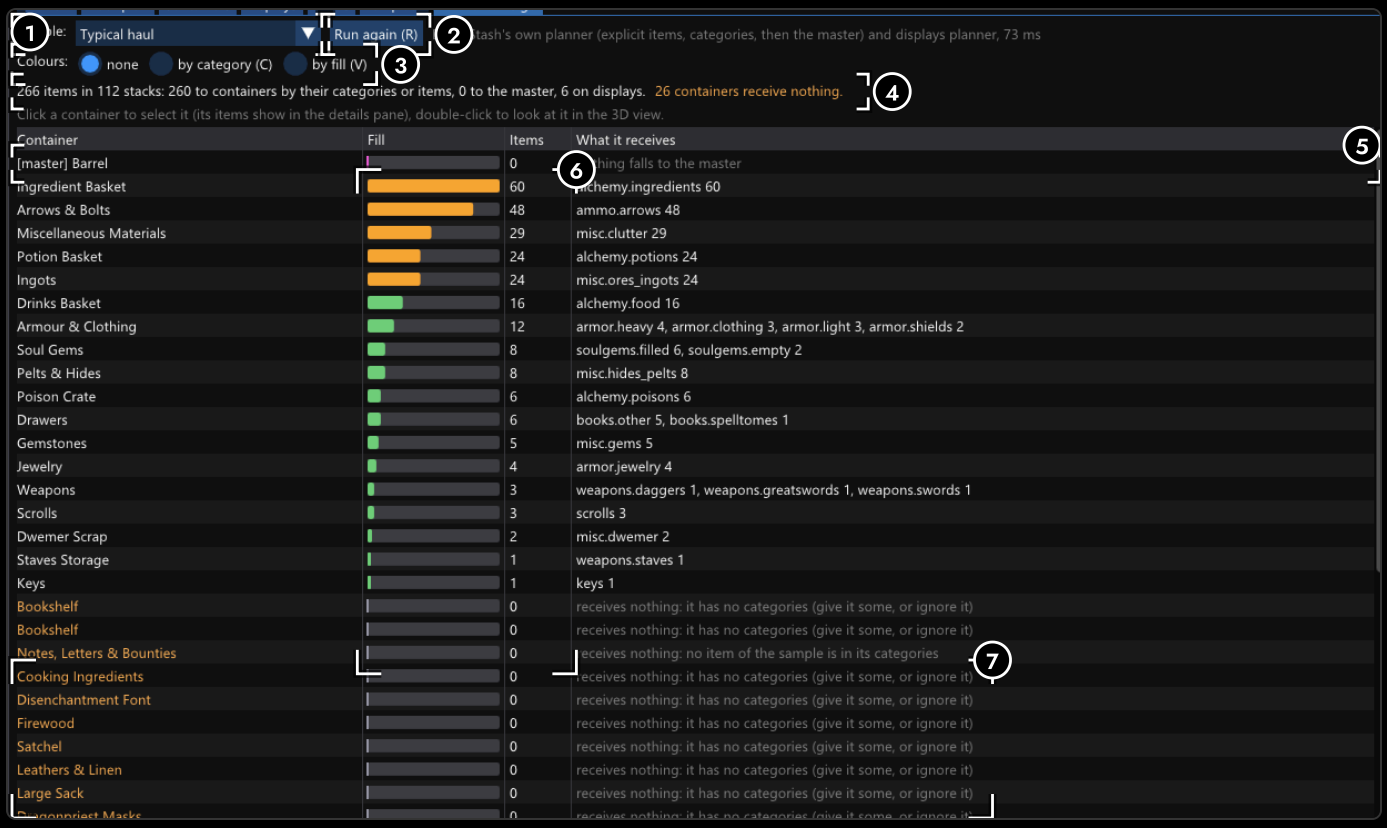


FIGURE 18 Where items go for Aldamar's draft, with the typical haul.

1. **Sample**: *Typical haul*, *One category*, or *Every item in the load order*.
2. **Run again** (R).
3. **Colours** for the 3D view and the plan.
4. **Summary**: how much goes to containers, the master and displays.
5. **The master**: what has no other place. Here, nothing.
6. **Fill** and item counts, per category.
7. **Receives nothing**, and why: give it categories or ignore it.

SAMPLES

Typical haul	A handful of each kind of loot, base-game items first (about 110 stacks). The quick everyday check.
One category	Every item of your load order in one category, such as `alchemy.*`: does all of it land where you expect?
Every item in the load order	One of each playable item, modded ones included. Shows what still falls to the master.

SEE IT IN THE HOME

Tick **by fill** (V) and go back to the 3D view or the plan: every container takes the colour of how much it would get. Click one to list its items in the details pane.



FIGURE 19 Colours by fill in 3D. The master, a barrel by the door, is selected; the green box beside it gets a few items.

1. **The key**: gray receives nothing, green a few (under 20), orange many, magenta the master.
2. **Containers** that get a few items.
3. **Master container**, selected.
4. **Its preview**: nothing falls to the master, so every item found a place.



FIGURE 20 The same colours on the floor plan.

1. **The same key** on the plan.
2. **The master**, in magenta.

By category

Tick **by category** (C) to colour each container by its first category instead, one hue per group: you see at a glance where the alchemy, the weapons and the materials live.



FIGURE 21 Colours by category: each container takes its first category's colour, one hue per group.

11

MULTI-CELL HOMES AND DOORS

Many homes are more than one cell: a cellar, a tower, the grounds with the forge. The **Doors** tab lists where the home's doors lead, so you can add those cells to the same home.

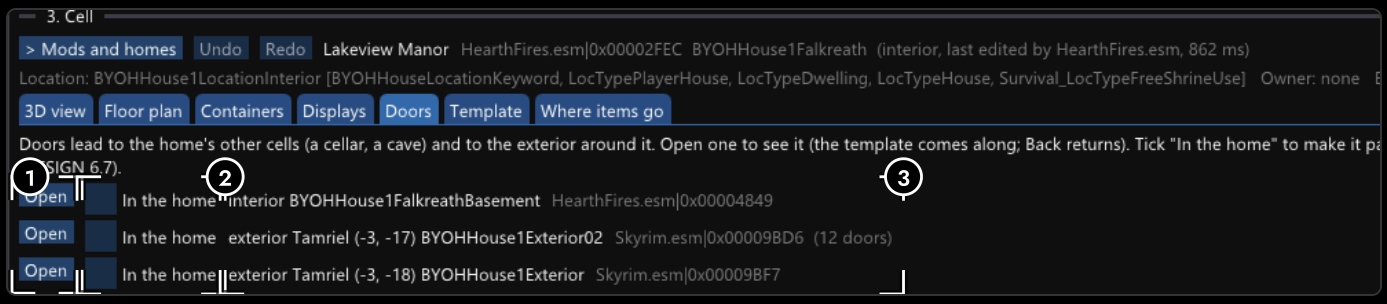


FIGURE 22 The Doors tab of Lakeview Manor: the cellar and the two exterior cells around it.

1. **Open** the cell behind the door. The template comes along; **Back** returns.
2. **In the home**: tick to make that cell part of this home.
3. **Where it leads**: another interior, or the exterior cells around the home.

ADDING A CELL

1. Open the home's main cell, then the **Doors** tab.
2. Tick **In the home** next to the cellar, or press **Open** and then **Add this cell to the home** in the details pane.
3. Set up its containers as usual. In 3D, double-click a door to walk through it.

ONE FILE PER HOME

However many cells, the home is saved as one template. Its cells are listed in the **Template** tab with their names (*Cellar*, *Grounds*), which players see in game.

Exteriors open with their terrain and the cells around them, so you can find the forge outside.



FIGURE 23 Lakeview Manor in the drafts view: one home over two cells, compared with its shipped template.

1. **More cells of this home**, found from their doors.
2. **The shipped template** and how far the draft agrees with it.
3. **Cell**: which cell each container is in.

12

CHECKING AND SAVING

The **Template** tab holds the template's details, checks it the way the game will, and saves it.

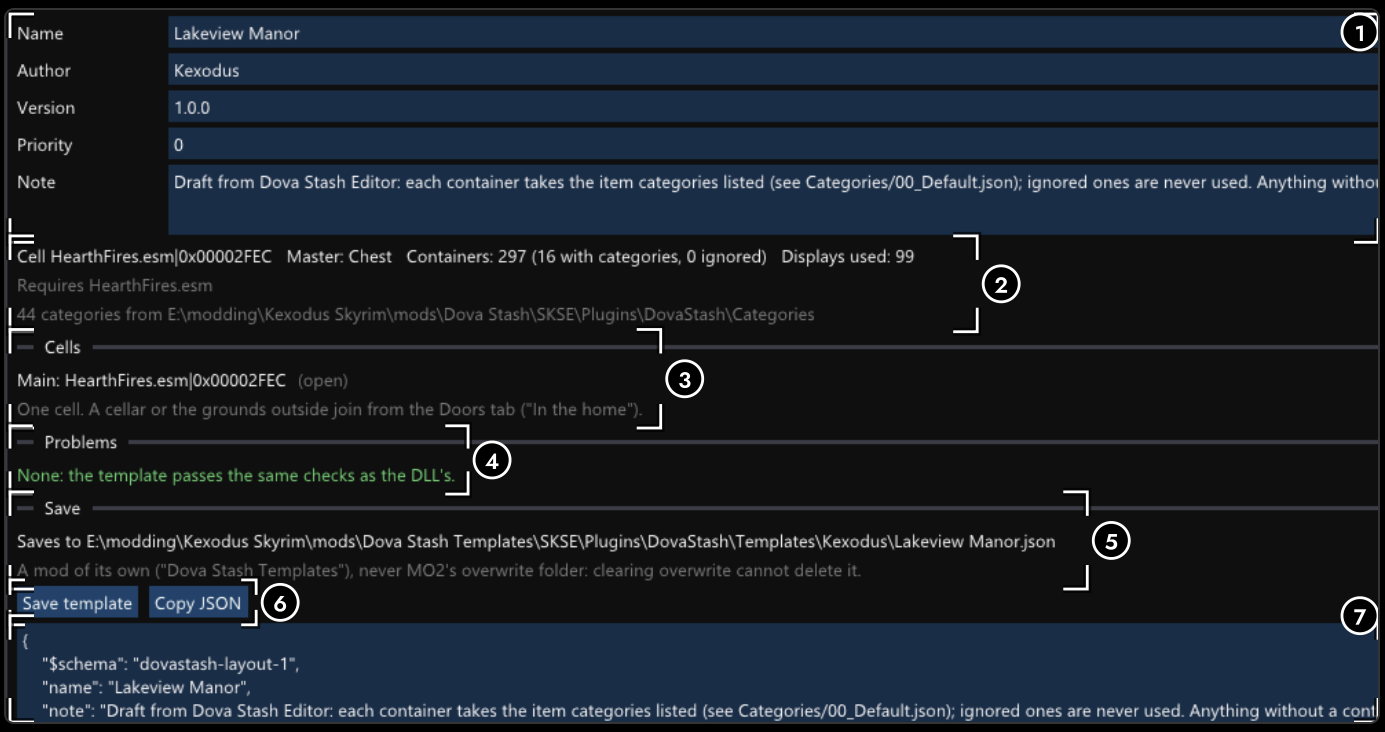


FIGURE 24 The Template tab: details, cells, problems and saving.

1. **Name, Author, Version, Priority, Note.** Your author name is remembered.
2. **Summary**: master, containers with categories, ignored, displays used, plugins required.
3. **Cells** of the home.
4. **Problems**: the same checks Dova Stash runs in game. Fix every error before you share.
5. **Where it saves.**
6. **Save template** (Ctrl S) and **Copy JSON**.
7. **The file** as it will be written.

WHERE IT GOES

Into a mod of its own, **Dova Stash Templates**, created when missing:

`mods\Dova Stash Templates\SKSE\Plugins\DovaStash\Templates\<Author>\<Home>.json`

Never MO2's overwrite folder, so cleaning overwrite cannot delete it.

THEN

1. In MO2, press F5 and enable **Dova Stash Templates** (first save only).
2. In game, look at a container in that home, press the hotkey and pick the template.

Saving over a file asks first, keeps the old one as a `.bak` and raises the version (1.0.0, 1.0.1...).

13

TROUBLESHOOTING AND FAQ

It says it cannot find my MO2 instance.

Type the MO2 folder in the top bar and press **Open**, or use **Browse...**. Or add `--mo2 "<MO2 folder>"` to the executable's arguments.

My home is not in the list.

Check the mod is enabled in the profile, then **Rescan**. Still missing: in **Any cell**, pick its mod and untick **Likely homes only**, or tick **Exterior cells too**.

Some surfaces are a gray checker.

The editor could not find that texture. It does not affect the template.

A container "receives nothing".

It has no categories, or none of the sample matches them. Give it categories, or ignore it.

I saved over a template by mistake.

The old file is next to it as a `.bak`. Rename it back to `.json`.

Can I edit a template I already have?

Yes: **Open a template...** (Ctrl O) on the start page opens a shipped or downloaded template, or a setup you saved in game, on its home.

The window stays black.

The editor needs Direct3D 11. Update your graphics driver.

The wrong profile is loaded.

Pick another in the **Profile** list at the top. The editor reads that profile's mod list and load order.

I cannot click a chest.

It may be hidden or behind a wall. Select it in the **Containers** tab, or turn off the **Structure** layer. Make sure **Select mode** is on.

Make master is grayed out.

That container respawns. Its contents can vanish, so it can never be the master; ignore it.

My template does not show up in game.

Press F5 in MO2 and enable **Dova Stash Templates**. Then check its **Problems** list and fix any errors.

Can it break my game?

No. It never edits plugins or game files. It only writes template files into its own mod.

How do I share a template?

Upload the `.json` file, keeping its `SKSE\Plugins\DovaStash\Templates\` folders. The template lists the plugins it needs.

Where are my settings kept?

In `%LOCALAPPDATA%\DovaStashEditor\state.json`: the MO2 folder, profile, author and each home's stage.

14

CONTROLS REFERENCE

3D VIEW

Right mouse held	Look around
W A S D	Fly (right mouse held)
Q E	Down, up (right mouse held)
Shift · Alt	4× faster · slower
Wheel	Forward, back; speed while flying
Middle drag	Pan
Alt + left drag	Orbit the selection
Left click	Select
Double-click a door	Open the cell behind it
F	Frame the selection
Home	Overview
S	Select mode on or off

FLOOR PLAN

Wheel	Zoom
Right or middle drag	Pan
Left click	Select
Left drag, select mode off	Pan

TABLES

Click · Ctrl + click	Select · add to the selection
Double-click	Select and look at it in 3D

SELECTING AND PAINTING

Ctrl + click	Add or remove one
Left drag (select mode)	Box select; Ctrl adds
Esc	Clear the selection
P	Paint mode on or off
C · V	Colours by category · by fill

ANYWHERE IN A HOME

Ctrl Z	Undo
Ctrl Y · Ctrl Shift Z	Redo
Ctrl S	Save the template
R	Where items go: run again
Mods and homes	Show or hide the lists
Back	Return to the cell opened before

EVERYWHERE

Ctrl D	Draft all homes
Ctrl O	Open a template file

DRAFTS VIEW

↑ ↓	Previous, next home
Enter	Open it in the editor
Ctrl S	Save its template
F5	Rescan the load order